

Jinnah's terms would have reduced the whole of the region to chaos and commotion like that prevailing in Pakistan. We would have had not just three countries, but more than 20 of them; allowing none to survive. By agreeing to Partition, Jawaharlal Nehru and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel saved us from the mess Jinnah had created.

VANI. A, *Hyderabad*

Partition did not herald stable peace in the sub-continent, thus negating the expectations of its creators. The after-effects of post-Partition riots, four wars, the Babri demolition, Mumbai blasts, Godhra carnage and never-ending Pakistan-sponsored terrorist attacks have made India a land of elusive tranquillity and harmony.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

Giant Lesson

China has far-sightedly realised that to achieve its goal of becoming a super-power, the economic reforms initiated by Deng Xiaoping have to be followed up with agricultural and land reforms to increase agricultural productivity for the nation ("The New Long March", September 7). The Communist country has also managed to keep potential revolt at bay by imbibing the disgruntled, impoverished people liv-

ing in the rural areas into its stupendous growth process. India, which is also fighting a losing battle against bridging the growth-hampering wide urban-rural and rich-poor divide, could take a tip or two from its neighbour.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Arms Way

National security should be given top priority by the Government and it should not be compromised at any cost ("The Missing Guns", September

apex level weapon purchasing committee headed by the prime minister.

The committee should be empowered to take fast decisions to be executed under strict timelines. The process should be made transparent and delivery-oriented to make our armed forces roar again.

BHASKAR BHATTACHARYA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Market Savvy

There is no doubt that foreign institutional investors (FIIs) are good for the country's economy but



Kerala is inexorably gaining notoriety as a haven for goons and terrorists. Business and financial institutions are invariably responsible for the rise of 'quotation gangs'.

K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN, *via www.indiatoday.in*

7). It is very unfortunate that we have not been able to acquire a single new howitzer since 1987. Arms and ammunition not only give strength to the armed forces, they also boost the morale of the soldiers. The Government should speed up the process by creating an

they alone cannot take us far ("Foreign Hand", September 7). Also, we can not afford to rely too heavily on FIIs as their impact on our market is purely sentiment driven, while for sustaining GDP growth, we need local expenditure, consumption, etc.

BAL GOVIND, *Noida*

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

NOVEMBER 1-15, 1979

A Nobel Mother

The person in question is Agnes Gouxha Bojaxhiu or simply Mother Teresa, 69. Last fortnight the world paid its tribute to her efforts to help the poor by honouring her with the Nobel Peace Prize for 1979. Four hours after receiving the news that she had been selected for the Rs 15,20,000 award, Calcutta's "living saint" quietly rode a streetcar, flashed her free pass, and headed for the Writers' Building, the communist state's Secretariat. There, as she humbly sought an interview with the ever-busy chief secretary, the not-so-busy peons, unaware that they were talking to a Nobel Prize winner, brusquely ordered her to "come back later". Towards the evening, as the tickers in the newspaper offices of Calcutta brought the Oslo-dated news, the city bent over backwards to pay its homage.

by Sumit Mitra



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